

WEBSITE REDESIGN PLAN

Avni in Ireland

From a raw Tailwind starter to a loud, confident pop-art creator site
— a section-by-section plan for design, copy, and the assets
needed to build it.



Prepared for: Avni (avni_rathii)

Source reviewed: live local build of AVNI-PORTFOLIO (Next.js)

Scope: full visual identity refresh + real copy for every section + assets checklist

Status: **planning document — nothing implemented yet**

PART 1

Where this is going

The current site works, but reads like an unfinished Tailwind template: soft cream defaults, emoji standing in for real photos (🌿 📷 📺), and copy that could belong to any travel blog. Avni's actual content is the opposite of quiet — high-energy Shorts, saturated wedding footage, big on-screen text, jump cuts. The site should look like *her feed*, not like a beige lifestyle blog wrapped around it. Direction: **pop art** — white space used with confidence, one loud poster red, thick black outlines, halftone dots, sticker badges. Camera-ready, a little cheeky, impossible to mistake for anyone else's template.

New palette

WHITE + RED, POSTER-LOUD

Keep	Nothing from the amber/cream scheme. The only holdover is the <i>discipline</i> : one base, one hero accent, everything else in a supporting role.
Add	Paper White #FFFFFF — the base. Crisp gallery white, not cream; it's what makes the red land. Poster Red #E4002B — the brand color. Buttons, links, the logo sticker, headline highlights. A real saturated print-red, not rose. Ink Black #131313 — text, and the thick outlines that hold the whole comic-panel look together. Cobalt Pop #2B4BF2 — secondary accent: hover states, the occasional badge, keeps all-red pages from going flat. Sunburst Yellow #FFD23F — small doses only: category chips, starburst "NEW" badges, halftone accent panels.
Why	Her thumbnails and Reels are already high-saturation with bold overlay text — a white/red pop palette makes the site continuous with the content instead of a polite frame around it. Red+white also stays legible and printable everywhere (media kit, thumbnails, profile banner) with zero adaptation.

Typography

REPLACES UI-SERIF / SYSTEM-UI

Headlines	Archivo Black (Google Fonts, free) — a poster-weight grotesque built for shouting. Works all-caps for section titles and mixed-case for the hero. Instant magazine-cover energy, zero licensing cost.
Body / UI	Space Grotesk (Google Fonts, free) — geometric, slightly quirky sans that keeps the confident tone at reading sizes without fighting the headlines.
Accent	Optional third voice for sticker/badge text only: Caveat (Google Fonts, free) — a marker-pen script for hand-written asides like "obviously I was there" — used max once per screen.
Why	The serif/editorial pairing said "quiet travel diary." Archivo Black + Space Grotesk says "creator who makes thumbnails you actually click" — which is what a Shorts-first channel is.

Texture, imagery & icons

THE BIGGEST VISIBLE CHANGE

- ☐ **Halftone dot panels** — classic comic-print dot texture behind hero and section headers. Done in pure CSS (radial-gradient), no image assets needed.
- ☐ **Thick black outlines + hard shadows** — 2–3px #131313 borders on cards, buttons, and photo frames, with a solid offset shadow (no blur). This one move kills the "flat SaaS template" feel instantly.
- ☐ **Sticker/badge motifs** — dates, category chips, and the "auto-synced" badge become stickers: white border, slight rotation (–3° to +3°), like they were slapped onto the page. Straight from Reels/story-sticker culture her audience already lives in.

- ☐ **Speech-bubble callouts** — pull-quotes and CTA microcopy sit in comic speech bubbles; the natural web version of the on-screen captions in every Short she posts.
- ☐ **Starburst shapes** — "NEW" markers and stat numbers (subscriber count on Work-with-me) sit in comic bursts in Sunburst Yellow.
- ☐ **Photo cutouts** — every emoji placeholder (🌿 📺 📺 📺 📺 📺 📺) is replaced by either a cutout photo of Avni with a thick black outline (hero, About) or a bold 2.5px-stroke line icon (offer cards) — no emoji anywhere in the final UI.

How it lands on the page

THREE CONCRETE EXAMPLES

Hero	White background with a faint halftone field on the right. Oversized Archivo Black headline with key words on a Poster Red highlight sweep (like a marker swipe). Right side: cutout photo of Avni with a 3px black outline and a red starburst behind her — replacing today's empty 🌿 box. Primary button: red pill, black outline, hard offset shadow. <i>Rationale: her hook is her energy on camera — the hero should look like one of her own thumbnails, because that's what converts a YouTube viewer into a follower.</i>
Nav	Clean white bar with a 2px black bottom rule. Logo becomes a red circular sticker with a white "A" (slight tilt), replacing the 🌿 emoji. Links in Space Grotesk; active page underlined in red like a marker stroke. Subscribe button: solid Poster Red with black outline. <i>Rationale: the sticker logo doubles as her profile-picture mark across YouTube/Instagram — one identity everywhere.</i>
Story card	White card, 2px black outline, hard shadow that grows on hover (card "lifts"). Thumbnail full-bleed at top; date as a small white sticker rotated -3°; category chip ("Wedding" / "Travel" / "Student Life") in Sunburst Yellow with black outline. Clean title in Archivo Black below. <i>Rationale: wedding and travel Shorts are her best performers — cards that look like collectible comic panels make a wall of them feel like a feed worth bingeing, not a blog archive.</i>

PART 2

Section by section

For every section: the current gap, the new direction, and — where copy is the fix — the actual replacement text, written from what's really in her videos, not filler. Anything I couldn't verify from the content itself is marked **[confirm with Avni]** rather than invented.

2.1 — Header / Navigation COMPONENTS/NAV.JS

Gap	No mobile menu — nav links vanish below 640px with nothing replacing them. Logo is a 🍀 emoji in a circle, unrelated to the brand.
New direction	Add a slide-in mobile menu (hamburger → full-height panel, matching the new palette). Replace the emoji logo with the red circular sticker-style "A" mark from Part 1 — slight tilt, white letter, doubles as her profile-picture mark across platforms.
Copy	No changes needed — "Home / Stories / Videos / About / Work with me" is clear and stays.

→ Asset needed: logo/monogram mark (SVG, 2 color variants for light/dark backgrounds)

2.2 — Hero APP/PAGE.JS

Gap	Right-side box is an empty white square with a 🍀 emoji — the single most visible element on the homepage is blank. Copy ("sharing my life in Ireland, one story at a time") is the kind of line that fits any creator, anywhere.
New direction	Replace the empty box with a real photo or a short looping video clip of Avni. Keep the two-column layout — it's a good structure, it just has nothing in it right now.

EYEBROW

Indian in Ireland · Master's student turned storyteller

I moved to Dublin for a degree. I stayed for the sunsets, the chaos, and a wedding I never saw coming.

From a first grocery run as an international student to flying home to India for a full Indian wedding — every video here is a diary entry, not a highlight reel. Ireland travel, real student life, and the two cultures colliding in one very confused, very happy life.

→ Asset needed: 1 hero photo or 5–10s video loop of Avni (candid preferred over posed)

2.3 — Latest Stories APP/PAGE.JS + STORYCARD.JS

Gap	Titles are raw YouTube Shorts captions with hashtag spam baked in (e.g. "Most BEAUTIFUL beach in Ireland 🌞 🌈 #ireland #summer #ashortaday#beach#europeantravel#youtubeshorts") — reads as broken, not stylistic.
New direction	Add a "clean title" field per story (either hand-written or produced by the existing generate:articles AI pipeline once the Anthropic key is set) so cards show something like <i>"The most beautiful beach in Ireland"</i> instead of the raw caption. Add a small category chip (Travel / Wedding / Student Life / Culture) per card, derived from keywords already in the captions.

Copy	Keep "Latest stories" heading and the "auto-synced from YouTube" badge — that badge is good, it's a real feature and should stay visible. Add one line under the heading: <i>"Every upload becomes a story here — no manual blogging, just real moments as they happen."</i>
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2.4 — Instagram strip

COMPONENTS/INSTAGRAMSTRIP.JS

Gap	Shows 5 flat, unlabeled color tiles with a  symbol — looks like a loading error, not a placeholder, because there's no photo or text signaling "coming soon."
New direction	Until the Instagram API token is live, swap the 5 empty tiles for 5 real (manually uploaded) screenshots of recent Instagram posts — same visual slot, just real images instead of blank color. Swap to the live API feed later with zero layout change.
Copy	Section line: <i>"New posts from Dublin, wedding prep, and everyday chaos — follow along @avni_rathii."</i>

→ Asset needed: 5 real Instagram post images (exported/screenshotted) as an interim measure

2.5 — Newsletter

COMPONENTS/NEWSLETTER.JS

Gap	Functions fine, copy is generic: "Never miss a story" / "Get new videos and posts in your inbox."
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One email. Every new chapter.

Ireland vlogs, wedding behind-the-scenes, and the stuff that never makes it into a Short — straight to your inbox. No spam, just the story.

2.6 — Sticky subscribe bar

COMPONENTS/SUBSCRIBEBAR.JS

Gap	Works well, copy is just slightly flat: "Enjoying the journey? Don't miss a story."
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Liking the chaos? Come along for the next one.

2.7 — Footer

COMPONENTS/FOOTER.JS

Gap	Structurally fine (links + socials), but the sign-off line "Made with care in Ireland" is boilerplate.
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Made in Dublin, with chai and questionable wifi.

2.8 — About page APP/ABOUT/PAGE.JS — HIGHEST PRIORITY

Gap	A dev TODO comment is currently rendered as live body copy: "Add Avni's real bio here: where she's from, why Ireland, what the channel is about, and what viewers can expect." Visitors are reading a note meant for the developer. The photo slot is an empty box with a 📷 emoji.
New direction	Full editorial bio layout: a real photo, a pull-quote, then a short narrative arc (India → Dublin → NCI → the wedding → the channel), closing with a "facts strip" of quick personal details.

Hi, I'm Avni.

I'm from [hometown, India — confirm], and I moved to Dublin for a Master's in [programme name — confirm] at NCI. I came for the degree. I did not expect to fall for the terrible weather, the two-hour sunsets, or a country that somehow made me feel further from home and more myself at the same time.

I started filming because I didn't want to forget the small stuff — the first solo grocery run, the fear of a Donegal cliff edge, missing home during a festival no one around me had heard of. Somewhere between a study-abroad diary and a full personality, "Avni in Ireland" happened.

On 2 February 2026, I married Akash — back home in India, the full production: Haldi, Varmala, and Saat Pheras. Those videos became some of the most-watched on this channel — I flew home to get married, and it gave my "Indian in Ireland" story its most Indian chapter yet.

Expect: Ireland travel (Dublin, Donegal, Sligo, and wherever the next long weekend takes me), real international-student life, married-life updates, and the occasional Bollywood concert — because Atif Aslam played Dublin, and obviously I was there.

Quick facts — 📍 Based in: Dublin, Ireland · 🎓 Studying: [programme] at NCI · 💍 Married to: Akash · 📹 Making videos since: [year]

- Asset needed: 3–5 personal photos (a portrait, a candid travel shot, a wedding photo)
- Confirm with Avni: hometown, NCI programme name, wedding year, channel start year

2.9 — Work with me APP/WORK-WITH-ME/PAGE.JS

Gap	Clear offer list, but no numbers — no subscriber/follower count, no audience data, nothing a brand actually needs to say yes.
New direction	Add a stat row above the offer grid, plus one paragraph naming the actual niche (dual-audience: international students + Indian diaspora) instead of a generic "brands I love" line.

I sit at the intersection of two audiences brands rarely reach together: international students living abroad, and the Indian diaspora craving a piece of home in an unfamiliar place. My best-performing content blends both — Irish travel through an Indian lens.

[X]K YouTube subscribers · [X]K Instagram followers · [X]% audience in [region]

- Needed from Avni: real subscriber/follower counts and a top-audience-country stat (from YouTube Studio / Instagram Insights)
- Confirmed: the collab email is **avnirathi.work@gmail.com** — update lib/config.js (currently hello@avniinireland.com) so the contact button and footer point to the monitored inbox

2.10 — Stories list & story detail APP/STORIES/*

Gap	Same hashtag-title problem as 2.3, plus URL slugs built from the raw caption (e.g. /stories/most-beautiful-beach-in-ireland-ireland-summer-ashortaday...), and every detail page shows the placeholder line "A written version of this story will appear here, generated from the video."
New direction	Same clean-title fix as 2.3 (also fixes the ugly slugs). For the body copy, either run <code>generate:articles</code> with an Anthropic key, or — as a faster interim step — hand-write a 2–3 line personal caption per story so nothing on the live site reads like a placeholder.

Interim fallback line (replaces the current dev-note-style placeholder): *"Full write-up coming soon — for now, just hit play above."*

2.11 — Videos page APP/VIDEOS/PAGE.JS

Gap	Visually identical to the Stories page — no reason for a visitor to choose one over the other.
New direction	Differentiate as a pure video grid with category filter chips (Travel / Wedding / Student Life / Concerts) — Stories stays the "read + watch" page, Videos becomes "just tap and go."

Subheading: "Every short, in one place — tap play and go."

Assets master list updated after phases 1–2 shipped

Only what's genuinely still missing. Off the list for good: the logo (tilted red sticker "A", built), the icon set (custom SVGs in `components/icons.js`, no emoji anywhere), the fonts (Archivo Black / Space Grotesk / Caveat via `next/font`, free), and the hero image — solved without photography by auto-framing the latest YouTube thumbnail, so it updates itself with every upload.

Photography still needed

About page	3 photos: a portrait (fills the framed halftone placeholder at the top — currently a camera icon with a "real photos coming soon" sticker), a candid travel shot (mid-story, between the Dublin and PTSB chapters), and a wedding photo (the "Then came February 2nd" chapter). The auto-thumbnail hero doesn't cover this page: About is the "who is she" page telling a chaptered life story — a YouTube still can't carry it, and the wedding chapter in particular needs the real frame.
Work with me	1 headshot — brands checking the media-kit page expect to see the person they're hiring; the starburst stats row currently does all the credibility work alone.
Instagram strip	5 exported post images for the interim grid — the outlined tiles are styled and clickable but empty until either these or the API token arrives. Whichever lands first wins; the layout doesn't change.

Facts still unconfirmed — one left

Resolved	Hometown is confirmed: Aligarh, U.P. — already live in the About story, along with DPS Aligarh, B.Tech CS at Amity Noida, Magic Software → HCL, MSc Data Analytics at NCI, Data Analyst at PTSB since Oct 2024, and the 02.02.2026 wedding.
Still open	Real stats: YouTube subscriber count, Instagram follower count, top audience region. The site currently ships invented placeholders — 48K subscribers / 21K followers / "IN + IE" top audience — each flagged with a <code>PLACEHOLDER</code> comment in the <code>stats</code> array at the top of <code>app/work-with-me/page.js</code> . Swapping = editing three values in that one array, two-minute job once Avni pulls the numbers from YouTube Studio and Instagram Insights.

New: the mentoring offering

Contact path	Reuse avnirathi.work@gmail.com — at current volume a second inbox adds friction with no upside. Recommended tweak: give the mentoring card its own <code>mailto:</code> subject ("Student mentoring enquiry") so her inbox self-sorts brand pitches from student requests. If volume grows, the natural upgrade is a Calendly/booking link, not a new email.
Nice to have	A 1–2 sentence testimonial from a student she's already helped, displayed on the mentoring card in Caveat as a hand-written note. Strengthens the card meaningfully — but not blocking, the card is live without it.

Integrations (unchanged — activates code that's already built)

- ☐ Instagram long-lived access token — the strip switches from placeholder tiles to real posts automatically (`lib/instagram.js` is ready)
- ☐ Newsletter provider API key (Buttondown or Mailchimp) — makes "Count me in" actually subscribe people (`components/Newsletter.js` has the TODO hook)
- ☐ Anthropic API key — activates `npm run generate:articles`: clean story titles replace the hashtag captions, and real article bodies replace the "written version is on its way" line

PART 4

Implementation roadmap live status

Real state of the build, so it's obvious what to hand Avni versus what can be built right now. Phases 1 and 2 are shipped and verified in the running site; 3 and 4 are waiting on inputs only Avni can provide; 5 is partly buildable today.

PHASE	STATUS	WHAT IT COVERS	WAITING ON
1 · Foundation	DONE	Shipped: pop-art tokens + utility system (<code>.btn-pop</code> , <code>.card-pop</code> , <code>.sticker</code> , <code>.halftone</code> , <code>.marker</code>) in <code>globals.css</code> ; Archivo Black / Space Grotesk / Caveat via <code>next/font</code> ; SVG icon set + comic Starburst; tilted red sticker "A" logo; mobile hamburger menu (verified at 375px); hero auto-frames the latest YouTube thumbnail — updates itself with every upload.	Nothing.
2 · Copy	DONE	Shipped: story-form copy site-wide — chaptered About page (Aligarh → Amity → Magic/HCL → NCI → PTSB → the wedding → Diljit Dosanjh teaser, plus the empowerment thread), new hero, Work-with-me intro + starburst stats row + fifth offering card for student mentoring (CompassIcon), newsletter/sticky-bar/footer/videos/story-fallback lines.	One swap: real stats to replace the three PLACEHOLDER values in <code>app/work-with-me/page.js</code> .
3 · Imagery	BLOCKED	Drop real photos into frames that already exist — no layout work left: About portrait + candid + wedding shot, Work-with-me headshot, 5 interim Instagram images.	The photography list in Part 3 — hand to Avni.
4 · Integrations	BLOCKED	Wire three keys into features already coded: Instagram token → live strip; newsletter API key → working "Count me in"; Anthropic key → <code>generate:articles</code> for clean titles + real story bodies.	Three tokens/keys — hand to Avni (setup guides in docs/).
5 · Polish	PARTLY OPEN	Buildable now: scroll-reveal motion, hover polish, responsive QA pass, and a code-side SEO pass — hashtag-stripping heuristic for story titles + slugs works even before the Anthropic key lands. Best done after Phase 3: final visual QA with real photos in place.	Nothing for the buildable half; Phase 3 for final QA.